

A Practical Study of PHILIPPIANS

THE GOAL OF CHRISTIAN LIVING

“Important Keys to Successful, Fulfilled Living”

Goal Number Five – The Day of Christ – Philippians 2:12-18

Retirement is stopping before you run the final lap. It's finishing before you finish. You don't spend very much time in the Bible before you realize that heaven is really a place for finishers.

When you read the Great Hall of Faith—Hebrews chapter 11—you see what these individuals went through and how they completed the task that was given to them.

Jesus is the masterful example. When He checks into the garden He says: “I finished the work You gave me to do.”

When He's hanging on the cross, that final cry of victory is the cry of the Olympic runner as he breaks the tape: “Tetelestai! It is finished!”

Life was designed to take us through many different phases of development. Ultimately it comes to that day when it's finished.

Now there are two things that can finish your life:

1. Physical DEATH or
2. the RAPTURE of the church.

That finishes any further opportunity.

God designed life like that. We really don't know when that particular hour is going to come for us.

We can say this with all honesty, we don't know of anyone who had expected it at the time that it came. We have a tendency to avoid those things and try to go on and live as though we're going to be here forever.

Maybe some of us are really running late in the race. We don't know. That's alright. We don't have to know.

The question is, are you running? Are you going to finish?

What it's going to be like in heaven to sit down with some of these Christians in the early church and talk together about life down here?

Here's this guy, he was beheaded for the cause of Christ or was eaten by the lions in the coliseum. He's going to look at you and he's going to say "Hey! Tell me a little bit about what you've been through!"

And you'll say "Ah well, my babysitter didn't come over when we were ready to go to the party. And boy we really lost a lot of money in black Friday."

Your talking to someone who put his life on the line. Tough to relate to that, isn't it?

We've become soft. We've become individuals who are guilty of wanting to stop before we finish.

There is a horrible, horrible disorientation that takes place when we stop before we finish.

If you're thinking that you've got some time here on the end just to blow a little smoke and do the things you've never been able to do in your life, you've got the wrong mentality. That mentality destroys the greatest potential for productivity.

The greatest army of unproductivity in the church today is not the young folks, it's the older folks who are wise and now are ready to be useful to God. The older generation has been given the opportunity for people to have a second career. It could be serving the Lord full-time somewhere.

There's a great army of people out there that are getting ready to retire but shouldn't. They should find out what God wants them to do and roll up their sleeves and finish strong.

We're going to be held accountable for our individual races. We mustn't be affected by how others run their race. We need to be motivated by the passage of scripture before we dig into the text a little more.

1 Corinthians 3:10-15

According to the grace of God, which was given to me, as a wise master builder, I laid a foundation and another is building upon it. But let each man be careful how he builds upon it. For no man can lay a foundation other than the one which is laid, which is Jesus Christ. Now if any man builds upon the foundation with gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, and straw, each man's work will become evident; for the day will show it because it is to be revealed with fire. And the fire itself will test the quality of each man's work. If any man's work which he has built upon it remains, he shall receive a reward. If any man's work is burned up, he shall suffer loss, but he himself shall be saved, yet so as through fire.

What Paul is saying, you can live your life perfectly selfishly, living only for you, living for things here and now, and end up having a bunch of wood, hay and straw at the Judgment Seat of Christ.

The Judgment Seat of Christ is not designed to cause us to lose our salvation. The Judgment Seat of Christ is simply going to evaluate how we've run our race.

Have you run with spiritual objectives in view? Have you been motivated by the Spirit or have you been living in the flesh?

The bottom line that comes out of that is if those days that we've been walking in the Spirit, fellowshiping with Him, and growing and maturing in Him are days when we're building with gold, silver and precious stone.

We start evaluating every day when we finish. Did I build today with wood, hay and straw? Or did I build with gold, silver and precious stone?

At the Judgment Seat of Christ there'll be reward in view of that.

This is not something that you're going to be able to avoid. There's a little word "all" here.

2 Corinthians 5:10

For we must ALL appear before the Judgment Seat of Christ, that each one may be recompensed for his deeds in the body according to what he has done, whether good or bad.

We're going to be held accountable for our individual races. Men, your wives can't run your race for you. Women, your children can't run your race for you.

Relationships are going to fail in insignificance when each of us individually stand before the Lord. How careful we must be about our own lives in view of that.

Now does that mean Christianity is for a bunch of wimps who really have to have an emotional push and are so weak that they've got to have religion in order to make it?

There are some pretty tough guys that are getting ahold of this truth and they're becoming competitive Christians. God is delighting in that.

Some guys who are saying "put up or shut up" and are willing to scrutinize life and to evaluate it and recognize how tough it is, have found adequacy in Jesus Christ. That's the apostle Paul.

1 Corinthians 9:24-27

Do you not know that those who run in a race are all running but only one receives the prize? Run in such a way that you may win and everyone who competes in the game exercises self-control in all things. They then do it to receive a perishable crown, but we an imperishable. I run in such a way, not without aim, I box in such a way, not beating the air. But I buffet my body and I make it my

slave lest possibly after I have preached to others, I myself should be disqualified.

2 Timothy 2:3, 4

Suffer hardship with me as a good soldier of Christ Jesus. No soldier in active service entangles himself in the affairs of everyday life, so that he can please the one who enlisted him to be a soldier.

Paul is getting ready to help us understand that it's on a daily basis that the difference is made.

It's day-in and day-out as we're faithful.

We've called this passage: THE DAY OF CHRIST.

We need to recognize that our ultimate goal is to be made like Christ.

In view of that, he's going to give us secondary goals:

1. The LOVE of Christ—teaching us how to allow love to flow through us.
2. The GLORY of Christ—so we're not threatened by somebody else, some brother or sister in the body of Christ who's more gifted or more talented, that we can only be doing all of this for the glory and praying that he/she is too.

3. The SUFFERING of Christ—that we recognize, when we're running uphill into the wind and things are hard, God is doing a work in our life that we don't understand, but it's going to work out.
4. The MIND of Christ—that we begin to think like He thinks so that we will begin to act like He acts.

The DAY of Christ—we have to see somehow a termination point in view of the stewardship and responsibility that we have while we're here.

That goal is lying out there.

It's out there somewhere and that's the finish line.

What is the FINISH LINE in all of this? How much time do we have left so that we can run a good race and finish?

Now one thing we start doing is checking how far we have to go. If we want to be a good, effective performer and stand at the Judgment Seat of Christ with incredible fashion, then we're going to bring all of your energies to bear in view of that.

The graying of America is taking place before our eyes. People are living longer. But we can't assume that! We have to understand what James chapter 4 says:

James 4:14

Your life is like a vapor that appears for a little time and then it passes away.

The DAY OF CHRIST is one of our goals. We're starting at verse 12.

v. 12 So then, my beloved ones, just as you always obeyed, not as in my presence only but now much more in my absence, with a reverential fear and trembling be working out your own salvation;

“So then, my beloved ones,”— he loves the Philippian people— “just as you always obeyed, not as in my presence only but now much more in my absence, with a reverential fear and trembling be working out your own salvation;”

Paul doesn't have any question at all that they're Christians.

Notice this word is “working OUT” it's not “working FOR.”

We can't work FOR your salvation. Once we enter into a relationship, we can begin “working out” that salvation in our life.

As believers, we need to be challenged to do that in view of the day of Christ and the finish line.

When we talk to an athlete as he gets ready to sign up for competition, what does he do? He goes to work out. He pumps

iron. He changes his diet. He goes to bed on time. He checks all the signals in his body chemistry because he wants to perform. We call that going to work out. Working out an ability and a skill, to refine it, to prepare it for the day that he's going to stand and perform.

As believers, in view of the day of Christ, in view of the Judgment Seat of Christ, we are told here with a sense of “reverential fear.” That doesn't mean that we're scared of God. It means with a sense of caution as to how serious this matter is, “with a reverential fear” and respect for who God is and His holiness.

The word “trembling” doesn't mean to go around shaking all the time. It does mean having the anxiety to do the right thing. It's wanting to please.

Have you watched that in kids? They have such an anxiety to please. As soon as they become teenagers they lose that.

There's something that happens there. There's a change. We're supposed to be like the little child that has a deep anxiety inside to please our Father and with reverential respect for Him, we want to do that which is going to glorify Him.

Hebrews 10:31

It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.

He says here, “be working out your own salvation.”

That’s in the PRESENT TENSE in the Greek text. It means that should be going on every day in our life. That means that we should be doing that today. You should be doing those things which are preparing us for that ultimate day.

Noah, in fear and trembling, took the instructions God gave him, built the Ark, and provided salvation for he, his wife, and his three sons and their wives—and a lot of animals.

That’s what the passage is teaching us.

“Be working out” the instructions that God has given us.

Let’s put SALVATION in its perspective of PAST, PRESENT and FUTURE.

There is SALVATION PAST when we were born again, when we received Christ as Savior.

There is SALVATION PRESENT where we’re focusing on right now. We are “working out” DAILY our “own salvation”—in “fear and trembling.”

There is a FUTURE SALVATION when ultimately we stand in His presence, completely perfect, made like Jesus Christ.

How do WE do it?

How do we develop the mind of Christ? Let's put these together.

We fill our mind with the Word.

How are we "working out your own salvation"? We fill our mind with the Word.

The more time we spend in His presence and in His Word, we're working these things out. As the Spirit of God reaches down and He nails us on some given area of our life, then we begin to change. That's working it out.

Psalm 34:8

O taste and see that the Lord is good. Blessed is the man who trust in Him.

There's a great little statement that is so true:

Failure to prepare is preparation for failure.
(source unknown)

If we're not "working out your own salvation," we're going to fail.

John dreaded that! He says:

1 John 2:28

Oh the horror of it all to shrink away from Him in shame at His coming.

Remember the story of a man who gave one guy 5 talents, another guy 2, and another guy 1? The guy with the one—we look at that and I think how horrible.

He has failed to be a steward of what God had given him. As a result he has to be embarrassed. So if it is our responsibility to be “working out [our] own salvation,” then we must be spending time in the Word so that our mindset changes, so we see suffering like it is, so we’re living for His glory, so we’re filled with His love! We’re becoming more and more like the Lord Jesus Christ.

This is a good verse for Christians:

Acts 1:11

You men of Galilee, why are you standing here gazing up into heaven? This same Jesus which is taken up from you into heavens shall so come in like manner as you have seen Him go into heaven.

Here they are standing around with their hands in their pockets, looking up and saying “Wow, He’s gone!” And the angels say “Why are you standing around here? The same Jesus is coming back again. So hurry up and get it done before He gets here!” That’s our responsibility.

People who are really making a mark for God are the most intense individuals around!

In a sense of intensity of purpose—not that they're under stress. We don't ever see Jesus under stress. We don't ever see Him saying, "I'm sorry I can't talk to you. I've got another appointment." You don't see Him saying, "Oh I'm so stressed out today. This has been rough. Oh I just hurt all over." We just don't hear that from Him.

We see a well-ordered life but we hear words from His lips like this:

John 9:4

I must work the works of him that sent me while it is day for the night is coming when no man can work.

There's an intensity of purpose about Him.

We've got a job to do! We've got a goal to reach! As believers we want NOT to be embarrassed or fruitless as we stand there in His presence.

F.B. Meyer says it well:

Then let us in the name and by the power of Jesus put away all that has been shown to be inconsistent with his character and claims. And let us submit in everything to his control. It will cost us something. We may have difficulty with our

judgment, warped and injured by self-preference. We may have to contend with our will, reluctant to sign the death warrant of some favorite habit. We may feel singularly powerless to carry into effect what we know in our loftiest moments to be our only safe and blessed policy. But happy are we if we dare to catch up the trailing robes of self-indulgence and restrain them under the total commitment of truth and purity.

(source unknown)

“...fear and trembling be working out”—on a daily basis—
“your own salvation.”

Verse 13—REASON.

v. 13 for God is the one who is working in you, both to desiring and to doing for His good pleasure.

“for God is the one who is working in you, both to desiring and to doing His good pleasure.”

All of this is in the PRESENT TENSE.

This goes on every day! We’re working it out because God is daily working in us!

As He works in us, He works in two areas. He works both in our “desiring” and our “doing His good pleasure.”

Now for some of us our problem is just simply desiring God’s

will for our lives.

For some of us who've walked with God a little longer and it's not the desiring of it, it's how to do it.

So God says, "Hey! I'm glad you have one of those two problems because I'm famous for working those out. You want me to work on your desires, I can do that. That's a pretty painful deal but I will work on it. I can make you change your attitude toward some things that you think are pretty important in your life if you want me to work on it."

"Let's sit down and talk about that crisis. I'll be glad to share a few of those toys that have been thrown aside in more recent days."

Things are not all that important any more.

Do we want His will more than anything in all the world?

Are we willing to do it?

He works on our WANTING and our WORKING.

He works on our PLEASURE and our PERFORMANCE.

He's working inside us.

Philippians 1:6

Being confident of this very thing, that He who has begun in you a good work will bring it to completion until the day of Christ Jesus.

And right now, if we're a believer, the Spirit of God's talking to us about something that He wants to do in our life.

Maybe it's our desires and something we really want is not what God wants for us. And God is saying, "Hey, it's going to be painful but I'm not going to let you have it. It's not going to be what I have for you."

He has to say no.

Prayer isn't getting God to do our will. Prayer is getting us into the position of desiring His will. Then God begins to work.

And we say, "Ok God! Fill me with the desire for what You want for my life!" And "Oh God, help me to do it."

Psalm 37:4, 5

Delight yourself in the Lord and He'll give you the desires of your heart. Commit your way to the Lord; trust also in Him and He will do it.

Some Christians read that verse and say, "Oh, I'm going to delight myself in the Lord and then He's going to give me the desires of my heart!"

No! When we delight ourselves in the Lord, He's going to change our desires! And then He'll grant it.

James 4:3

You see, when you do ask, you don't get it because your whole aim is wrong. You want only what will give you pleasure.

That's it.

We want it to consume our desires. God says no.

Yes, delight yourself in Him and in His good will, and He will grant the new desires of your heart.

v. 14 Be doing all things without secret complainings and inward questionings;

“Be doing all things without secret complainings and inward questionings;”

As you work out your own salvation, don't go around griping and complaining about everything.

Realize that God delights in someone who is positive and up.

Philippians 2:3, 4

Don't be doing it from selfish ambition and from empty

conceit, but regarding one another as excelling themselves; not looking each one out for his own interests, but also each one for the interests of the others.

Our attitude toward the will of God reveals our level of submission to the will of God.

If we're bouncing around and we're all upset and anxious about it and concerned, it reveals we haven't yet submitted to it.

That's Jacob. As soon as those 10 boys come back and Simeon isn't with them, Jacob just goes up in smoke. Those boys say, "Look, we're not going to get any more grain unless you let Benjamin go." He just digs his heels in and he is so resistant and stubborn! "All these things are against me!" He doesn't desire the purpose and the will of God which is to get the seed into Egypt right now. He's going to have a lonely life for a while.

The day comes when he is so hungry, like the Prodigal son longing to fill his stomach with the husks that the pigs are eating. He finally comes to his senses and he says, "How many servants of my father have more bread than they can eat and I'm perishing here with hunger?"

So Jacob says, "go buy us a little grain." And the boys say, "Dad, we ain't going unless you send Benjamin."

"Dad you're so stubborn. If you'd let Benjamin go, we could

have already made two round trips and there wouldn't be any poverty in our house! Now don't stick your head in the sand like an ostrich and think it's gonna go away! The issue is Benjamin! Now give him to us and let us go and we'll get grain."

"If I perish, I perish. If I'm bereaved, I'm bereaved. Take Benjamin and go!"

What happens?

Air Force One shows up in the driveway.

The last 17 years of his life are spent in high cotton.

God's not waiting today for you to say, "Ok Lord, I'm giving it over to you!" SMASH! "That's just what I've been waiting for!" CRACK!

What if one of your kids came running in and said, "You know what I decided today? I decided for the rest of my life I'm going to do just exactly what you want me to do!"

"Alright kid! Boy, wait till you see what I've got for you when you get home!"

That's the lie of the devil. Some of you are squirming like crazy about the lack of submission to the will of God for your life because you think you know better than He does about what's going to make you happy. You're hanging on to some

stuff.

The only reason we flounce around in verse 14 with “secret complainings and inward questionings” is because we’re hanging onto something we know God has His finger on and we don’t want to turn loose of it because it’s our comfort zone—it’s our little smelly closet.

This story is so relevant:

(My Heart, Christ’s Home by Bob Munger)

Christ is in the house and then Christ says “I smell something rotten in here.” And the guy says “Yeah, I know. It’s in the closet upstairs but you ain’t getting it.” And then Jesus says “Well, I’m moving out on the porch.” As He starts to walk toward the porch, the guy realizes hey, he’s got to have the closet. He turns around and gives Him the key and in a minute the closet’s cleaned out and the Lord settles down in the hearth.

(source unknown)

Verse 14 sure tells us like it is. We start blaming God and we start as though it doesn’t exist but it’s there and it keeps us from the joy that could be ours if we simply surrender to Him.

Merlin Carothers wrote a book called *The Power to Praise*. He says something wonderful about praise:

(Power in Praise by Merlin Carothers)

Grumbling comes so easy to all of us that we often don't realize what we are doing. But grumbling is the very opposite of thanksgiving. A complaint is the opposite of trust. A murmur against your wife when she burns your toast is the opposite of loving acceptance. The dictionary defines a complaint as an accusation. By complaining and grumbling, you are actually accusing God of mismanaging the details of your day. The attitude of praise releases the power of God in our lives, and the attitude of murmuring and complaining blocks that power. And don't murmur against God and his dealings with you, as some of them did, for that is why God sent his angel of death to destroy them. All these things happened to them as examples, as object lessons to us, to warn us against doing the same things.
(source unknown)

Martin Luther said:

The devil is a chronic grumbler, and the Christian should be a living doxology.
(source unknown)

v. 15 in order that you may become blameless and innocent, children of God, above reproach in the midst of a crooked (dishonest) and depraved (distorted) generation, among whom you are shining as lights in the world,

“in order that you may become blameless and innocent,

children of God, above reproach in the midst of a crooked (and dishonest) and depraved (distorted) generation, among whom you are shining as lights in the world,”

That’s the whole purpose behind running a good race and giving Him all of it so that He can work out in our lives these things. We can sing to Him, “You light up my life!”

We are that light! And as people see Jesus in us, they’re drawn to that light in the midst of a crooked and distorted generation, where to shine His light.

Remember in the Sermon on the Mount when Jesus says:

Matthew 5:14

You are the light of the world.

Are you? Are you living and shining for Him? Sharing Jesus Christ with those who are around you because they sense there’s something in your life that’s missing in their own?

Jerry White says this:

(Honesty, Morality, and Conscience by Jerry White)

In college he grew a beard, and he wore overalls, and dirty t-shirts and did drugs. Then he graduated, shaved his beard, bought a new blue suit and joined the corporate treadmill. He married, had two children, joined the right clubs, and bought

a home in the suburbs. He sold his soul to the company. Then his wife left him. He divorced her; became a playboy, and then remarried. He was promoted by his company. He cheated on his taxes, his travel reports and his wife. He did none of these things because he deeply wanted to or thought he should. Rather, they were the right things to do. They were acceptable. Everybody was doing them. Yes, he was very, very successful and very, very unhappy.

Life had become a masquerade. By now he hardly knew who he was. Come to think of it, he was a little bit of everybody. Although fiercely claiming independence, he actually would do nothing that might endanger his standing with his peers. He might well describe himself as an American newspaper editor Emile Henry Gavreau did as being “a part of that strange race of people aptly described as spending their lives doing things they detest to make money they don’t want, to buy things they don’t need, to impress people they dislike.”

[Wow!] The influence of people on people is a powerful force, affecting everyone. Only the power of God and the innate drive for physical survival outrank it. A reasoning mind can become powerless in the face of this pressure. Even the most committed individualist conforms in some way to the lifestyle of others.

(source unknown)

That’s what he’s saying.

Be a light because your light is going to touch, influence and affect others!

It's out of that we have a chance to witness.

Jesus told Nicodemus:

John 3:19, 20

This is the judgment, light has come into the world and men love darkness rather than light because their deeds were evil. For everyone who does evil hates the light and does not come to the light lest his deeds should be exposed.

v. 16 holding fast (forth) the word of life, to the end that I may have a ground for glorying in the day of Christ, because I ran not in vain nor labored in vain.

“holding fast (or holding forth) the word of life, to the end that I may have a ground for glorying in the day of Christ, because I ran not in vain nor labored in vain.”

He says, “Keep on holding to it! Batten down the hatches! Bury some anchors! Manifest some stability!”

So that when it comes time to stand before the Lord, we're going to be able to glory in the fact that we came to know Jesus Christ. And as we give account to Him, we will not have run in vain or labored in vain.

Why is the “day of Christ” the goal? That's the FINISH LINE.

Jesus said, “I’m going to prepare a place for you.” (see John 14)

“If I go on to prepare a place for you, I’m going to come again.”

1 Thessalonians 4:16

The Lord will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, with the trumpet of God and the dead in Christ shall rise first.

That’s the mystery of:

1 Corinthians 15:51

We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed in a moment, the twinkling of an eye...

That’s the culmination of the good work that we saw back in chapter 1 and verse 6.

So the apostle Paul says, “I’m running toward the finish line.”

Are you? Is your life kind of put out in increments so that you know what you’re going to be doing in the next 5 years? In the next 10 years? In the next 20? Do you have an idea in mind of how you want to finish that race?

Every single day we should be making a contribution toward

our goals 5 years. Retirees don't have a right to sit down before they finish. You have to have goals and objectives for that last lap of the race. It is the extra effort that produces excellence.

There's where the rubber meets the road. That's when we realize what we're made of.

v. 17 But even if I am being poured out as a drink offering upon the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am joying and rejoicing with you all.

“But even if I am being poured out as a drink offering upon the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am joying and rejoicing with you all.”

That's exactly the characteristic of Jesus who emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant.

Now look at Paul. He says, “Look, I don't care. I am glad to be spent.”

That's taking the glass of wine and pouring it over the offering.

He says, “If I'm that in your life, that's great. I'm willing to be poured out for you.”

1 John 3:16

By this we perceive the love of God, because He laid down His life for us, and we ought to lay down our lives for our brother.

v. 18 But you also, be rejoicing in the same thing and be rejoicing with me.

“But you also, be rejoicing in the same thing and be rejoicing with me.”

Fill our heart with joy in view of the fact that we have the opportunity to be spent.

These are the lessons we get from the passage.

Lesson #1: We are commanded to work out our own salvation with fear and trembling.

Lesson #2: God is working in our lives, both on our desires and our doing of His good will.

Lesson #3: We are to abstain from secret complaining.

Lesson #4: We are commanded to shine as lights in a crooked world.

Lesson #5: Paul is running the race of his life in view of the day of Christ.

Lesson #6: We can have joy on being spent in His service.

Here are a couple of things in closing.

Phidippides was the fleetest of foot among his countrymen, the Greeks, having borne himself gallantly in the great battle at Marathon, he darted from the field immediately after victory was secure, and he ran all the way to the city of Athens. He related his tidings to the fathers of the city, closing with these words: "Rejoice ye, as we rejoice," and then, utterly exhausted by wounds and toil, he fell dead before them.
(source unknown)

That's the finish.

"Rejoice ye, as we rejoice."

Hebrews 12:1, 2

Seeing we are encompassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, strip down, and the sin which so easily entangles around our feet, and let us run with endurance the race that is set before us. Looking unto Jesus, the author and finisher of our faith, who for the joy that was set before him, endured the cross. Despising the shame he sat down as a finisher at the right hand of the Father.

Father, in these critical days when we feel like the rapture of the church could happen today, may we be those who are

zealous. May we be those who are wise. Your Word tells us to number our days and to apply our hearts to wisdom. Father, help us to be diligent, to make some projections spiritually of where we want to be and how we want to run and what has to go. Father, intensify the desires of these beloved children of Yours to want Your will more than anything else in the world. And then not only wanting it, being willing to do it and to do it with all of their hearts. Father, we're looking forward to that fantastic day of revelation when in Your presence we stand, made complete like Your Son, glorying in the finished work of what Christ has done on the cross but also in the finished work in our lives. And now unto Him who is able to guard you against stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of His glory with exceeding joy, to the only wise God our Savior, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forevermore. Amen.

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THE GOAL OF CHRISTIAN LIVING

“Important Keys to Successful, Fulfilled Living”

GOAL NUMBER FIVE – THE DAY OF CHRIST – PHILIPPIANS 2:12-18

KEY VERSE 2:16

v. 12 So then, my beloved ones, just as you always obeyed, not as in my presence only but now much more in my absence, with a reverential fear and trembling be working out your own salvation;
v. 13 for God is the one who is working in you, both to desiring and to doing for His good pleasure.

v. 14 Be doing all things without secret complainings and inward questionings;

v. 15 in order that you may become blameless and innocent, children of God, above reproach in the midst of a crooked (dishonest) and depraved (distorted) generation, among whom you are shining as lights in the world,

v. 16 holding fast (forth) the word of life, to the end that I may have a ground for glorying in the day of Christ, because I ran not in vain nor labored in vain.

v. 17 But even if I am being poured out as a drink offering upon the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am joying and rejoicing with you all.

v. 18 But you also, be rejoicing in the same thing and be rejoicing with me.

NOTES

QUESTIONS:

1. Read Philippians 2:12-18 and in your own words pull out the main thought of this passage.

2. What are we asked to do in verse 12?

3. What does God do for us in verse 13?

4. How are we supposed to do things, according to verse 14?

5. What is our job in the world, according to verses 15 and 16?

6. How can we fulfill the command to “hold fast the word of life”?

7. Explain what you think Paul means by the statement in verse 17.

8. What are we asked to do in verse 18?

9. Which verse in the study has meant the most to you?

10. What lesson have you learned from this study?

LESSONS FROM THE PASSAGE:

What are some of the lessons we can learn from this particular study?

LESSON #1: We are commanded to work out our own salvation with fear and trembling.

LESSON #2: God is working in our lives, both on our desires and our doing of His good will.

LESSON #3: We are to abstain from secret complaining.

LESSON #4: We are commanded to shine as lights in a crooked world.

LESSON #5: Paul is running the race of his life in view of the day of Christ.

LESSON #6: We can have joy on being spent in His service.